

XPRIZE
QUANTUM
APPLICATIONS

Google
Quantum AI

Presenting Partner: **gesda** 

Phase II Wild Card

Process Document

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Version 2.0

Please ensure you have read the PHASE I RULES AND REGULATIONS (“Rules”), which govern the XPRIZE Quantum Applications competition. To access the Rules, you must create a POP profile and navigate to the [Resources section](#). The Rules still apply to Phase II of the competition and complement and expand upon the Competition Guidelines posted [here](#).

All participating Teams must adhere to these Rules to remain eligible to progress through competition milestones and qualify for selection as winners of the competition. Failure to comply with these Rules may result in consequences as detailed in the Competitor Agreement, which can be found in the Resources section.

This version supersedes version 1.0. See Appendix C: Rules Revisions Change Log, for a record of notable changes to the Rules.

Note: Terms that appear in bold throughout this document are defined in the Glossary of Terms section in Appendix A.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

1. Introduction and Scope	3
2. Wild Card Navigation Guide	3
3. Judging of Wild Card Submissions	5
4. Phase II Wild Card Timeline	6
5. Phase II Wild Card Entry	6
5.1. Criteria for Phase II Wild Card Entries	7
5.2. Process for Consideration and Review	7
Appendix A: Glossary of Terms	9
Appendix B: Rules Revisions Change Log	10

1. Introduction and Scope

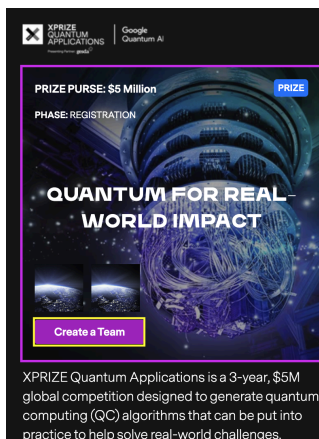
The Phase II Wild Card Registration provides a structured entry point for teams that were not able to register during the original competition windows, as well as teams that were not advanced to Phase II following Phase I Submissions. This pathway allows both new and returning participants to join the XPRIZE Quantum Applications competition, provided all entry requirements are met by **March 4, 2026**.

Participation via the Phase II Wild Card requires full compliance with competition requirements, including submission of a Phase I Submission and full execution of the Competitor Agreement. Teams that previously submitted a Phase I Submission must also provide a Change Document describing any updates or modifications from their prior submission, or explicitly stating that no changes have been made.

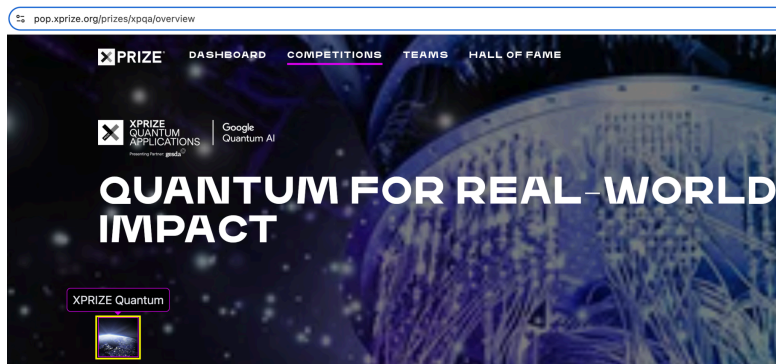
2. Wild Card Navigation Guide

To join via the Wild Card Registration Period, follow these steps:

1. Navigate to the Prize Operations Platform ([POP](#))
2. Create a Team Profile



3. Click into Your Team Dashboard



4. Go to the Activities Section - Locate the Wild Card Phase II activities.



5. Complete the Following Activities in Order:

1. Registration Form
2. Registration Fee Payment*
3. Competitor Agreement Signing**
4. Phase I Submission & Change Document (For those who submitted Phase I)

**Registration fee waivers are available for teams with demonstrated financial need. Please complete this [form](#). Teams that paid during a prior registration period are required to pay again. Waiver requests may be submitted to qc-apps@xprize.org.*

***If your team name, members, and entity remain unchanged from your initial registration, you do not need to complete a new Competitor Agreement. Please email qc-apps@xprize.org if you would like to reuse your previous agreement.*

The Competitor Agreement must be completed by March 4, 2025. No exceptions will be made.

3. Judging of Phase II Wild Card Submissions

Once submitted, your Phase II Wild Card entry will be reviewed by the Judging Panel Chair. This review is **not blind**. Team identities may be visible to the Chair, who may, at their discretion, involve additional judges.

Competitor Agreements must be submitted before teams can be officially admitted. If there have been no changes, previously submitted agreements may be reused.

If you submitted a Phase I Submission, you must include a **Change Document** outlining any updates or modifications from your prior submission.

Submissions will be evaluated in accordance with the Phase I Submission criteria and guiding questions set forth in the Phase I Rules and Regulations.

The Judging Panel Chair's decision is final. No feedback will be provided on Wild Card evaluations.

Teams will receive official notification of their Wild Card submission outcome via email no later than April 30, 2026.

4. Phase II Wild Card Timeline

Teams entering through the Phase II Wild Card Registration period must complete the following steps to become Official Competitors and become eligible to submit a Phase II Submission.

Phase II Wild Card Entry Timeline

Competition Milestone	Deadline	Requirements	Awards & Benefits	# Teams
Wild Card II Submission	11:59 PM Pacific Time on March 4, 2026	Complete submission on POP and HotCRP (See section 2 of Phase I Rules and Regulations)	Entry into the Competition for Phase II	Open to All

5. Phase II Wild Card Entry

This Wild Card period is designed to ensure the competition remains inclusive of high-quality, innovative ideas and to address any identified gaps in the submission pool.

5.1. Criteria for Phase II Wild Card Entries

Wild Card entries will be evaluated based on the following:

1. Team Quality: Assessment of the team's expertise, track record, and capacity to deliver an impactful contribution.
2. Published Work: Evidence of high-quality publications in the quantum computing field, such as peer-reviewed publications or preprints (e.g., arXiv submissions). XPRIZE will evaluate and share non-identifying information with the Judging Panel.
3. POP submission
4. Narrative document uploaded in POP and HotCRP
5. Teams that previously submitted a Phase I document must include a **Change Document** with their Wild Card submission. The Change Document should clearly describe any updates, revisions, or modifications from the prior Phase I Submission, or explicitly state that no changes have been made. Team identities will be visible to the Judging Panel Chair during the review process, who may, at their discretion, involve additional judges. Competitor Agreements must be submitted before teams can be officially admitted, and previously submitted agreements may be reused if unchanged.

5.2. Process for Consideration and Review

Any team (new team or current team that did not complete registration) interested in being considered for a Phase II Wild Card entry must complete the following steps:

1. POP Profile Creation: Interested Teams Leads must create a complete profile on the [Prize Operations Platform](#) (POP).
2. Review the XPRIZE Quantum Applications Competition Guidelines found here <https://www.xprize.org/prizes/qc-apps/guidelines>.
3. Teams must review the Competitor Agreement prior to submitting the Phase II Wild Card entry to ensure alignment with its terms, including fulfilling the requirement to form a legal entity for any team that is composed of more than one natural person. Any questions or concerns regarding the Competitor Agreement should be raised with the XPRIZE team before proceeding to Step 4 (Submit an Expression of Interest). The Competitor Agreement can be found in the RESOURCES tab at <https://pop.xprize.org/prizes/xpga/resources>.
4. Full submission of all POP forms and HotCRP submissions

If all requirements are fulfilled, XPRIZE will share the Wild Card submission with the Judging Panel Chair for review. The Judging Panel Chair may either approve the Wild Card submission directly or, at their discretion, involve the Judging Panel to review the submission. Judges will assess the Wild Card submission against the above criteria and will either approve or reject the Wild Card submission based on their evaluation. The Judging panel will provide no feedback on a Wild Card submission, and the decision of the Judging Panel is final, see [Competition Guidelines](#). Teams will be notified of the outcome of their Wild Card submission review by XPRIZE via email.

Appendix A: Glossary of Terms

Wild Card Entry: A designated entry pathway for teams not registered during the main window. Wild Card entries must be approved by the Judging Panel Chair.

Judging Panel Chair: The lead judge responsible for reviewing and approving Wild Card entries.

Appendix B: Rules Revisions Change Log

Record of notable changes to the Phase II Wild Card Process Document Version 1.0 compared to this Version 2.0:

Page 1:

- Added “This version supersedes version 1.0. See Appendix C: Rules Revisions Change Log, for a record of notable changes to the Rules.”

Page 5:

- Changed “Submissions will be evaluated based on: • Demonstrated expertise of the team • Alignment with competition goals • Quality and clarity of the submission materials • Relevance and impact of past work” to “Submissions will be evaluated in accordance with the Phase I Submission criteria and guiding questions set forth in the Phase I Rules and Regulations.”
- Changed “no later than March 31, 2026” to “no later than April 30, 2026”.

Page 6:

- Changed “Complete submission on POP (See Section 2)” to “Complete submission on POP and HotCRP (See section 2 of Phase I Rules and Regulations)”
- Added “3. POP submission”
- Added “4. Narrative document uploaded in POP and HotCRP”

Page 7:

- Added “4. Full submission of all POP forms and HotCRP submissions”